THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS

Master of Business Administration

Mentality Management and Decision-making

A. GENERAL INFORMATION

Instructor:	WANG Tao
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Pre-requisites:	None

B. COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course aims to help MBA students enhance his/her decision-making capability through the practice of meditation and mindfulness. This is the understanding from instructor's decades exploration of meditation and mindfulness, both theoretically and practically, and his experience in the business world, especially from investment and trading. But the insights are well beyond investment and trading, permeating every aspect of business and everyday decision-making.

When we make business decisions, emotion is a critical factor prone to interfering with sound decisions. Without a good mentality, any theories and methods are like great buildings on sands, which can collapse in a moment. Beyond business, other aspects of our lives are similar, if we cannot see reality objectively, immersed in the illusion created by our mind, or overwhelmed by fear or greed, we cannot make wise decisions because of all these disturbances.

Mentality management may be the most important determinant in business decision-making, as mental state determines the result of decision-making. Though we may be unaware of its importance very often. Sound Mentality management ensures the long-term success of our business and life. If we keep balance in our mind, we are not easily disturbed by outside turbulence, we will not defeat ourselves by making rudimental mistakes. With good mentality, not only can we lay a strong foundation for success in career, but also happiness in life.

The state of Zen has invaluable value for decision-making. The state is hard to fathom for people without experience, and the way to learn it must come through experiencing. Zen is closely related to the Sanskrit word "dhyana". It is a special state of consciousness. In this state, a person's consciousness can communicate smoothly with his/her unconsciousness. Consciousness is aware of what happens in the unconsciousness. The person connects to the inner wisdom, detached from desires, emotions and thoughts. This state is often thought to come from meditation and mindfulness practices, but it can happen in actions and everyday life.

C. COURSE OBJECTIVES

The course is designed to help student achieving the following by lecture and practice:

- Mastering basic mindfulness practices
- Seeing reality objectively
- Managing emotion, especially greed and fear
- Improving decision making
- Understanding the essence of leadership
- Balancing life and work

D. PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES

PLO 1.	Acquisition of knowledge and understanding of various business concepts and skills
PLO 2.	Application of business knowledge to analyze and solve real business situations
PLO 3.	Inculcating professional ethics and competency in business
PLO 4.	Developing global outlook
PLO 5.	Mastering communications and interpersonal skills in business settings
PLO 6.	Developing managerial leadership

E. COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Course Learning Outcomes		**Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes (PLOs)**
CLO1	Improving quality of decisions	PLO1, PLO2, PLO6
CLO2	Understanding deeper about leadership	PLO3, PLO6
CLO3	Basic understanding of phenomenological approach	PLO1, PLO2, PLO3
CLO4	Deep understanding the relevance between ESG and each of us	PLO3, PLO4, PLO6

F. COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Course Teaching and Learning Activities		**Aligned Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)**
T&L1.	Lecture with interactive presentation	CLO 1, 2, 3, 4
T&L2.	Exercise	CLO 1,3
T&L3.	Case-based study and analysis	CLO 1, 2
T&L4.	Self-study	CLO 1, 2, 3, 4

Assessment Methods		**Brief Description (Optional)**	**Weight**	**Aligned Course Learning Outcomes**
A1.	Class participation - Attendance 5% - Discussion 15%		20%	CLO 1, 2, 3, 4

A2.	Exercises	Besides lectures on knowledge and scientific backgrounds, the class will introduce some practical exercises to manage emotion, especially some meditation or mindfulness techniques, drawn from Eastern culture	20%	CLO 1, 2, 3, 4
A3.	Essay	Students will need to write an essay at least 1500 words to describe what they learn from the class, any insights they gain, and most importantly, how to use what they have learned in their everyday work and life.	60%	CLO 1, 2, 3, 4
		Total	100%	

G. STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT

COURSE GRADE DESCRIPTORS

A+, A, A-	Candidate has demonstrated a thorough grasp of the subject and has done an excellent project.
B+, B, B-	Candidate has demonstrated a substantial grasp of the subject and has done a good project.
C+, C, C-	Candidate has showed evidence on understanding some of parts of the subject, but insufficient. Candidate has done a reasonable project.
D+, D	Candidate fails to show sufficient understanding of the subject and does poorly in the project.
F	Candidate does not understand most of the subject and the project is incomplete.

H. ASSESSMENT RUBRICS FOR EACH ASSESSMENT

Grade	Course Grade Descriptor
A1. Class participation	
A+, A, A-	Show originality and supply deep and correct understanding of the subject
B+, B, B-	Show originality and provide relevant understanding of the subject
C+, C, C-	Provide relevant understanding of the subject
D+, D	Fail to provide relevant understanding of the subject, but show some ability to do so
F	The discussion/sharing is totally irrelevant
A2. Exercises	
A+, A, A-	Show originality and supply deep and correct understanding of the subject
B+, B, B-	Show originality and provide relevant understanding of the subject
C+, C, C-	Provide relevant understanding of the subject
D+, D	Fail to provide relevant understanding of the subject, but show some ability to do so
F	The performance is totally irrelevant
A3. Essay	

A+, A, A-	Show originality and supply deep and correct understanding of the subject
B+, B, B-	Show originality and provide relevant understanding of the subject
C+, C, C-	Provide relevant understanding of the subject
D+, D	Fail to provide relevant understanding of the subject, but show some ability to do so
F	The essay is totally irrelevant

I. COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE

The teaching is divided into 4 sections:

Part One
Introduction: decision-making and Mentality management
Scientific and physiological evidence
Key aspect: being present and centered
Basic meditation exercises

Part Two
More introduction on being present
Theory U: I-in-me, I-in-it, I-in-you, I-in-now
Exercises of being present
Tell the difference of real and imagined information
Phenomenological approach

Part Three
More introduction on being centered
Interreference of greed and fear in decision-making
Exercises of being centered
Key tips on practical emotion management

Part Four
More introduction on sound decision making
Is feeling important in decision-making process?
Unification of two ends
On risk management

J. REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS (e.g. journals, textbooks, website addresses etc.)

Wang, Tao (2025). Present and centered – Decision-making Mentality Management. Posts & Telecommunications Press. （汪滔，2025 年 3 月，《当下和中正——决策心态管理》，人民邮电出版社）
Scharmer, Otto (2028). The Essentials of Theory U: Core Principles and Applications. Berrett-Koehler Publishers.
Embree, Lester (2011). Reflective Analysis. A First Introduction into Phenomenological Investigation. Zeta Books.

K. MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

The SFTL questionnaire is one of the ways HKU courses and teaching are evaluated. HKU places significant importance on student learning and on the continuous enhancement of teaching and learning outcomes. Students are asked to complete this evaluation of their learning experiences at the conclusion of each course in which they enroll. Questionnaire items relate to the overall evaluation of the course as well as an evaluation of teaching.

In addition, students are encouraged to talk to the teacher or teaching assistant to give feedback about teaching during the breaks and after the class every day.

L. COURSE POLICY (e.g. plagiarism, academic honesty, attendance, etc.)

The University Regulations on academic dishonesty will be strictly enforced. Please check the University Statement on plagiarism on http://www.hku.hk/plagiarism/ .

Cheating or plagiarism of any kind would result in an automatic F grade for the course plus strict enforcement of all Faculty and/or University regulations regarding such behavior. Incident(s) of academic dishonesty will NOT be tolerated.

Academic dishonesty is a behavior in which a deliberately fraudulent misrepresentation is employed in an attempt to gain undeserved intellectual credit, either for oneself or for another. It includes, but is not necessarily limited to, the following types of cases:

a. Plagiarism - the representation of someone else's ideas as if they are one's own. Where the arguments, data, designs, etc., of someone else are being used in a paper, report, oral presentation, or similar academic project, this fact must be made explicitly clear by citing the appropriate references. The references must fully indicate the extent to which any parts of the project are not one's own work. Paraphrasing of someone else's ideas is still using someone else's ideas, and must be acknowledged.

b. Unauthorized Collaboration on Out-of-Class Projects - the representation of work as solely one's own when in fact it is the result of a joint effort.

c. Cheating on In-Class Exams - the covert gathering of information from other students, the use of unauthorized notes, unauthorized aids, etc.

d. Unauthorized Advance Access to an Exam - the representation of materials prepared at leisure, as a result of unauthorized advance access (however obtained), as if it were prepared under the rigors of the exam setting. This misrepresentation is dishonest in itself even if there are not compounding factors, such as unauthorized uses of books or notes.

M. ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION (e.g. e-learning platforms & materials, penalty for late assignments, etc.)

This course is more of an interactive class with experiential exercises. If classroom setup allows, it might be taught in an open U shape seats setting, instead of standard setting with tables in front of each student. The teacher faces the students with no table in front of students.